

Plant chefs

Pale topsoil worms eat soil, and poo it out in a different form. Plants absorb this as food. Topsoil worms can be more than three times as long as surface worms.

Topsoil worms burrow sideways.

Casts (poo) fill up the burrows, so the worms make new ones.

Casts provide much-needed nutrients for plant roots.

Plant Food

Plants can't just take in other plant matter as food. They need it to be broken down into nutrient-rich material by worms or microorganisms.

Worms of the deep

Deep burrowing worms are about the size of a pen. They are powerful burrowers, who make and maintain vertical burrows.

Deep burrowers live for up to 10 years.

Adults have a saddle (ring) near their head.

Young earthworms have smooth bodies.

Worm plumbers

Undisturbed vertical burrows can last for 30 years. These are important channels, which allow water and air to move through the soil.